

# CEL: Comprehensive Counterfactual Explanations Library and Benchmark

Oleksii Furman · Łukasz Lenkiewicz · Marcel Musiałek · Maciej Zięba

Wrocław University of Science and Technology, Wrocław, Poland

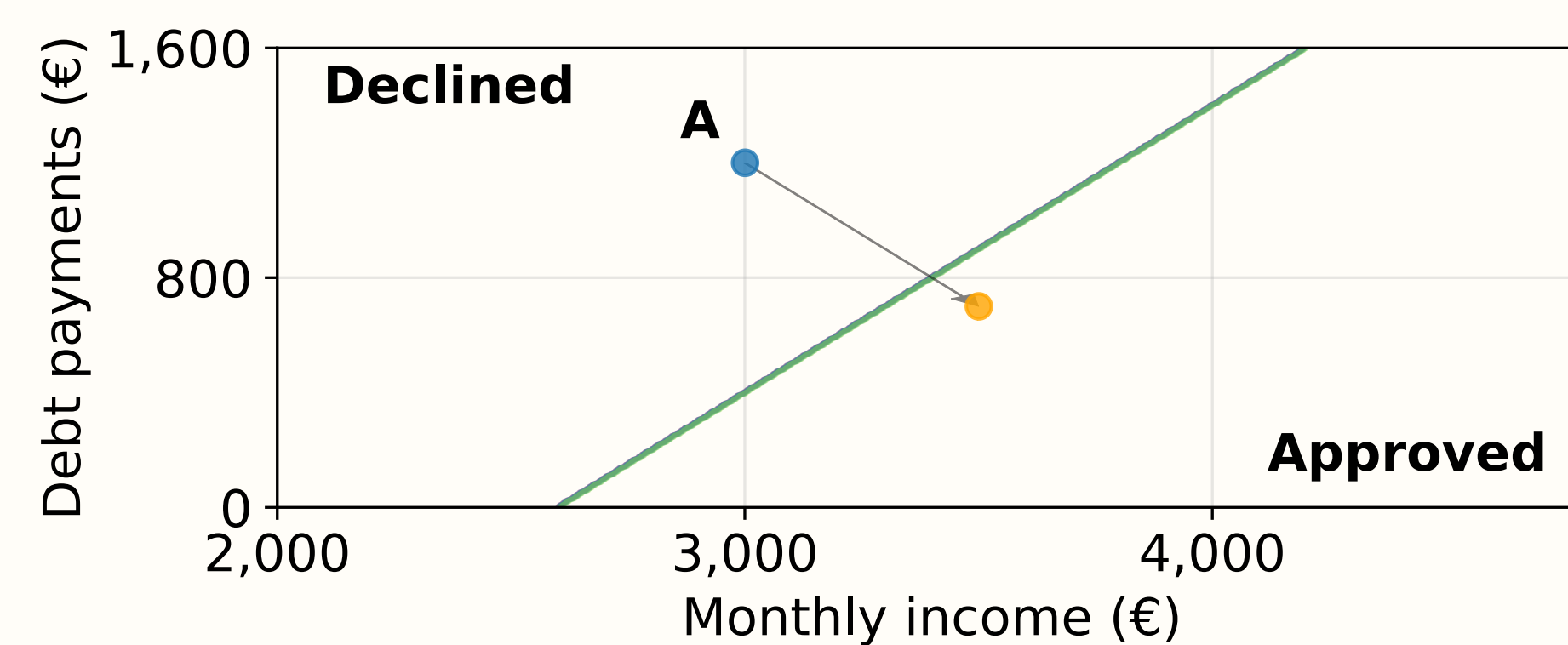
## What is a counterfactual explanation?

A small input change that flips a model's prediction.

### LOAN APPLICATION EXAMPLE

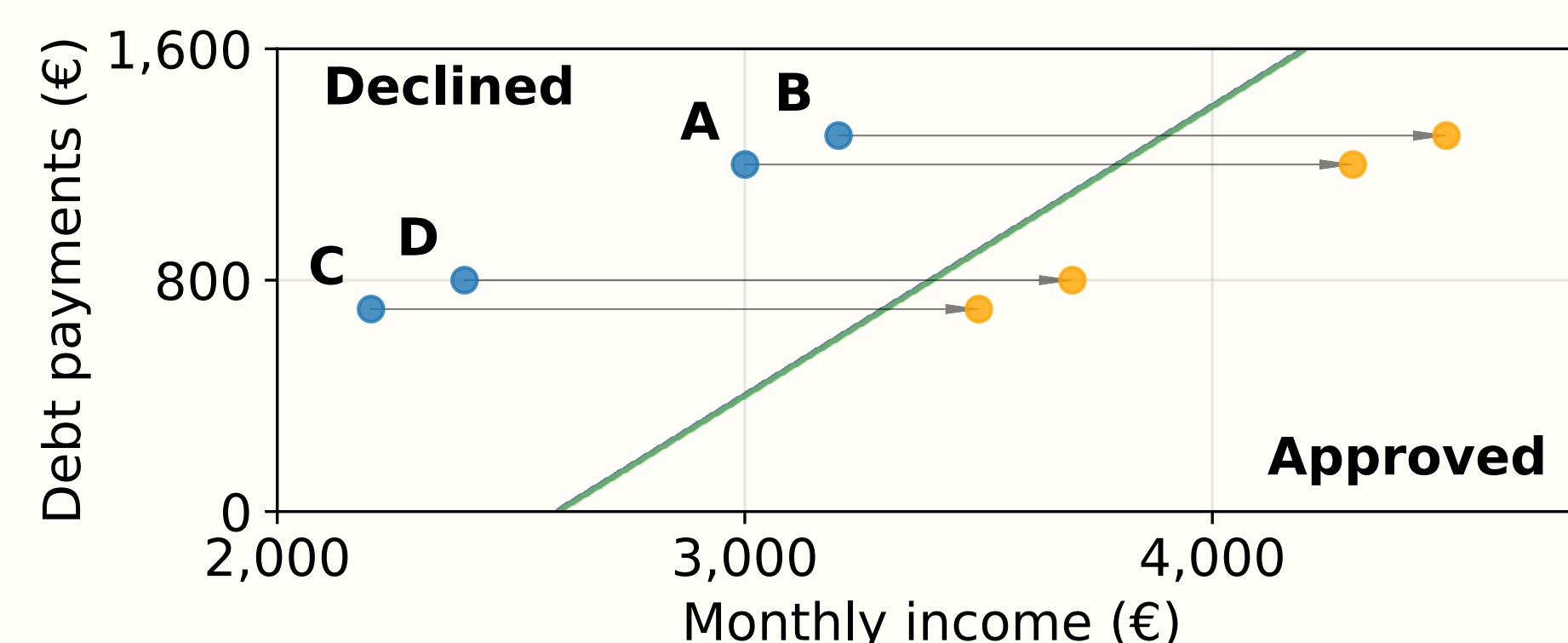
Local One applicant

| €/month        | Original A | Counterfactual |
|----------------|------------|----------------|
| Monthly income | €3,000     | €3,500         |
| Debt payments  | €1,200     | €700           |
| Employment     | Full-time  | Full-time      |
| Prediction     | Declined   | Approved       |



Global One shared change

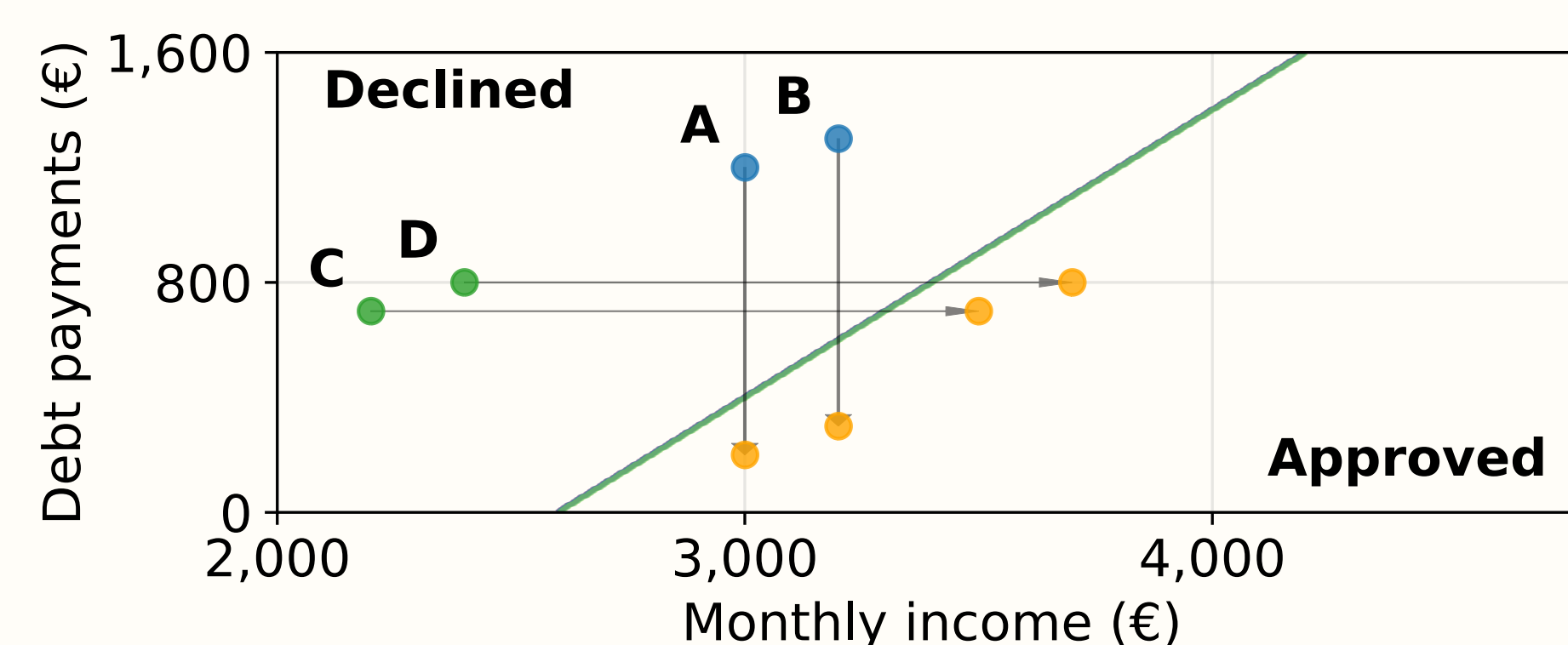
A-D Income +€1,300; debt unchanged.



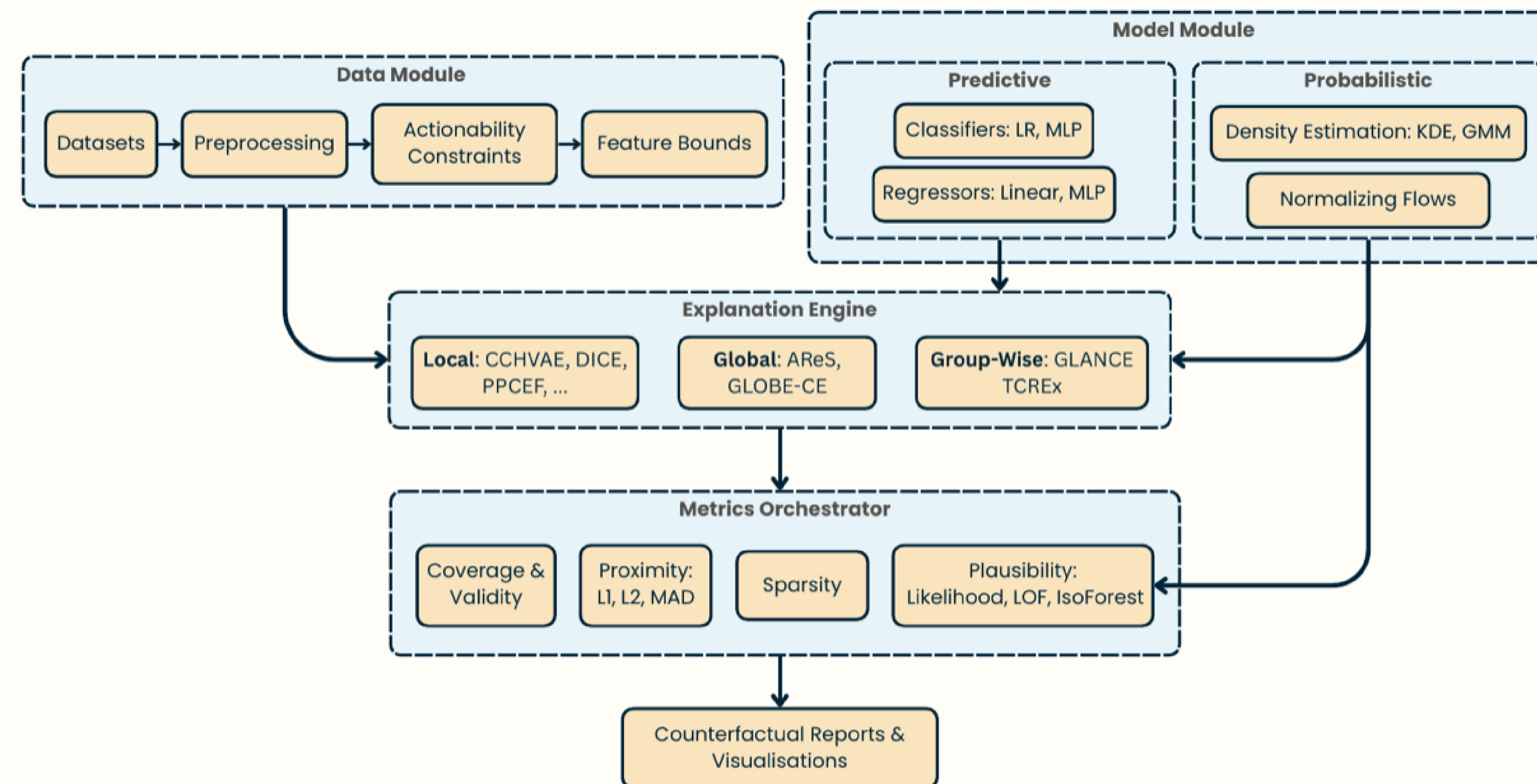
Group-wise One change per group

A-B Debt -€1,000; income unchanged.

C-D Income +€1,300; debt unchanged.



● Original ● Counterfactual — Decision boundary



## 18 Datasets

### Classification

Adult Census · Audit · Bank Marketing · Blobs · Credit Default · Digits · German Credit · Give Me Some Credit · HELOC · Law · Lending Club · Moons · Wine

### Regression

Synthetic · Concrete · Diabetes · Yacht · SCM20D

## 14 Methods

### Local

Wachter · Artelt · DICE · CCHVAE · PPCEF · CEM · CEGP · CADEX · SACE · CEARM

### Global

AReS · GLOBE-CE

### Group-wise

GLANCE · T-CREX

## 2 Backbones / Task

### Classification

Multi-Layer Perceptrons (MLP) · Logistic Regression

### Continuous targets

Linear Regression · MLP Regressor

## 9 Classification Metrics

Coverage · Validity · Sparsity · Prob. plausibility · Log-density · LOF · Isolation Forest · Proximity (L2 / L2-Hamming) · Runtime

## Three contributions

### CONTROL

Controlled evaluation protocol

### COVER

Broad benchmark across CE paradigms

### EXTEND

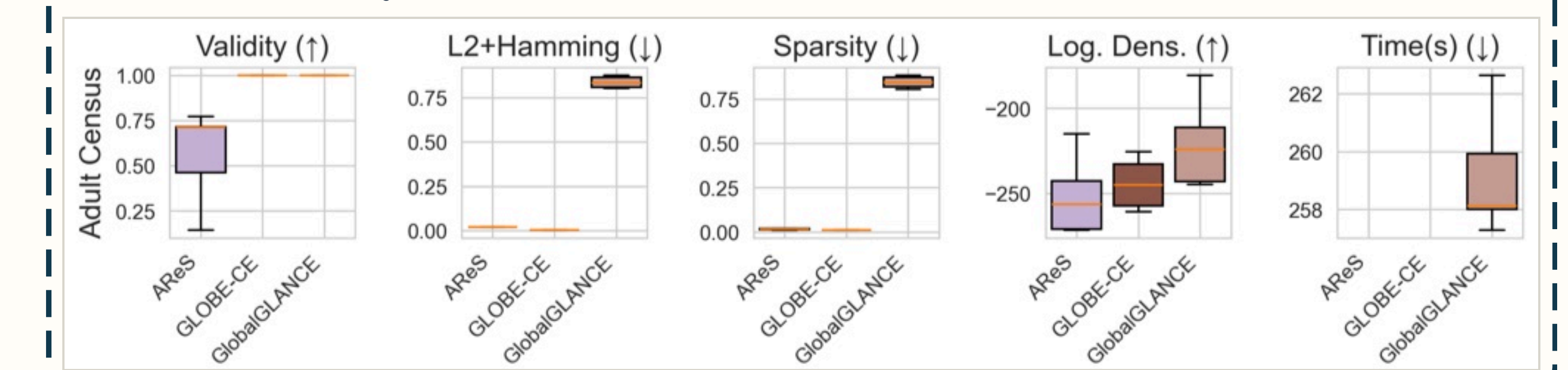
Extensible open-source benchmark workbench



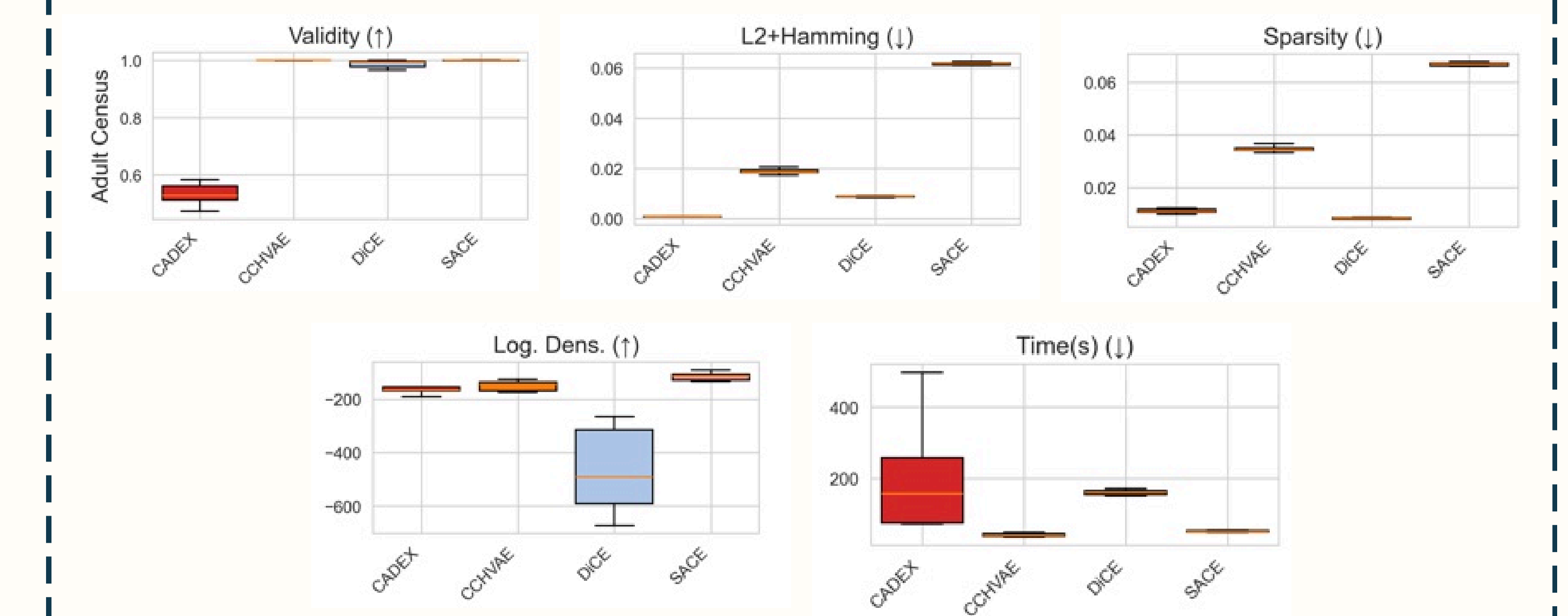
Code & project

## Results

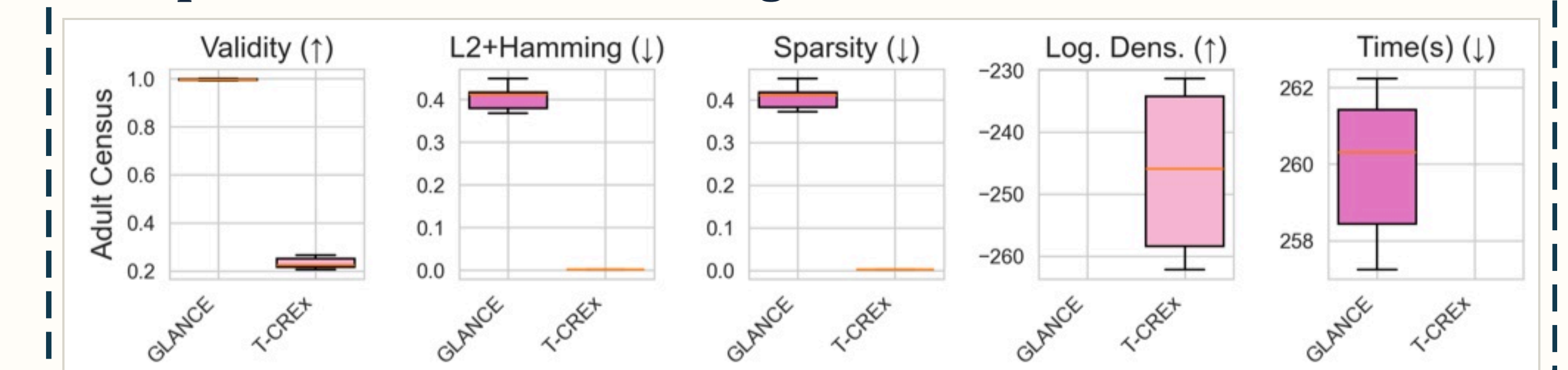
### Global: validity and failures



### Local: no single winner



### Group-wise: reach versus change



### Regression: accuracy versus change

